

Abdul Jabbar v. State of Uttar Pradesh and 2 Others

Allahabad High Court · Division Bench · 12 August 2025 · 2025:AHC:136469-DB · Writ - C No. 27039 of 2025 · **Writ disposed; licensee directed to comply with the Lok Adalat bill-correction order.**

HEADNOTE

A Lok Adalat award directing correction of electricity bills is not answered by pointing the consumer to Clause 6.5. Section 22-A of the Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987 treats supply of power as a public utility service. The Court directed the supply company to comply forthwith with the 11 December 2024 Lok Adalat order and to communicate the result within two weeks.

FACTUAL SUMMARY

Abdul Jabbar had applied to the supply company for compliance with a Lok Adalat order dated 11 December 2024 regarding correction of bills. Counsel for the supply company submitted that the Lok Adalat order was ex parte and that the petitioner had to raise a dispute under Clause 6.5 of the Electricity Supply Code, 2005.

HOLDING-UNITS

INTERPLAY · UP-2005::6.5

Lok Adalat award vs Clause 6.5

HOLDING

Where a Lok Adalat has already directed correction of electricity bills, the licensee's submission that the consumer must raise a Clause 6.5 dispute does not prevail. Section 22-A of the Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987 includes supply of power as a public utility service. The Court directed the supply company to comply forthwith with the 11 December 2024 award and to make the result known within two weeks of communication of this order. ¶ 2-4

NOT DECIDED — NEGATIVE AUTHORITY

NOT DECIDED — WHETHER THE LOK ADALAT ORDER WAS MADE EX PARTE, AS THE LICENSEE SUBMITTED

The Court did not decide that objection; it directed compliance under s.22-A LSAA. ¶ 2-3